

MANUSCRIPT

A Novel

CHARACTERS

Captain Maya Rodriguez

Experienced starship commander with a mysterious past

rank: Captain, ship: Stellar Voyager

CHAPTERS

Chapter 1: The Signal

Captain Maya Rodriguez stared at the blinking alert on her console. The Quantum Compass in her palm vibrated faintly, responding to something unseen in the void beyond Andromeda Outpost's sensors.

"Another false alarm," she muttered, but her fingers tightened around the ancient device. For three months, the compass had been silent. Tonight, it woke up.

She initiated a level-three diagnostic, preparing to investigate whatever disturbance had triggered the alert. The stars outside the viewport seemed to hold their breath.